PG Tandem Rating — Requirements and Documents

Apex Adventures (Paramotor SA (Pty) Ltd, SACAA DTO 0012) · Paragliding (PG) tandem rating · Compiled 26 Oct 2026 from CAR Part 62 Subpart 8, SA-CATS 62 Appendices R62.35 / R62.37, the SAHPA Training and Procedures Manual (TPM) and SAHPA's 2025 forms.

1. Who this is for

PG Sport pilots who want to fly paying or training passengers on a **tandem paraglider**. Your initiating tandem instructor does the final sign-off; the SAHPA Committee considers the application.

2. Before you start

- PG Sport licence held for at least 12 months, and a PG rating held for at least 24 months (CAR 62.08.1(4); R62.35 asks for Basic held at least 2 years)
- No incidents or accidents displaying negligence or incompetence in the prior 6 months
- Register with SAHPA as a Trainee Tandem Pilot before you start; you receive an info pack with the documents required
- Class 4 medical declaration signed by a medical practitioner
- Level 1 First Aid certificate

3. Experience requirements

Requirement	Figure
Solo flights	At least 300 high flights (SAHPA TPM: 300 logged solo flights)
Airtime	At least 150 hours total solo
Tandem flights	At least 40 flights on a tandem paraglider
First 10 tandem flights	With a tandem-rated Grade B instructor or higher, accurately logged: the first 3 as passenger, the rest as pilot in command
PIC with tandem pilots	10 flights as pilot in command with tandem pilots
PIC with Basic-rated pilots	20 flights as pilot in command with at least Basic-rated PG pilots, after your Authority to Fly is issued
Passenger weights	Flown with at least 2 different tandem-rated passengers whose weight differs by at least 20 kg
Time as PIC	At least 3 hours as pilot in command

Requirement	Figure
Winch-trained pilots	At least 5 flights, one as passenger with a tandem-rated instructor, from a mountain site with 200 m or more height difference

The Authority to Fly (ATF) is issued only after the theory exam is passed and the medical certificate is presented, and before you fly with non-tandem-rated pilots.

4. Theory exam

- Tandem licence exam, **pass mark 85%** (SA-CATS R62.37)
- Subjects: General Knowledge and Air Law, Paraglider Structure and Aerodynamics, Navigation and Airspace, Flying Skills and Airmanship, Meteorology and Airflow, Aeromedical

5. Practical course

To be completed within one calendar year of starting (SAHPA TPM), with all tasks in SA-CATS-FCL 62.08.5.3:

- Unassisted forward launch in less than 5 km/h wind; forward launch in more than 15 km/h (may be assisted); reverse launch in at least 12 km/h
- Pendulum control and big ears
- Two 30-minute flights in thermal conditions at a site, at 11:00 and 15:00
- Flights from at least 3 different sites, and at least 5 mountain launches, two with the instructor as passenger
- Flights close to the minimum and maximum weight range of the wing, using passengers of different weights
- Landing accuracy: 3 out of 3 in a 15 m radius circle; a nil-wind landing; and a landing in strong wind (20 km/h or more), unassisted, with pilot and passenger staying on their feet while dropping the wing
- Good attitude to airmanship

Equipment: a certified tandem wing, a tandem-rated reserve and equipment on all tandem training flights. The reserve is compulsory on all flights.

6. Documents to submit

#	Document	Notes
1	SAHPA Paragliding STD Tandem Pack (2025) and Tandem Rating Application Checklist	Signed by the initiating instructor
2	Marked written Tandem exam	85% or higher
3	Class 4 medical declaration	Signed by a medical practitioner
4	Level 1 First Aid certificate	Valid
5	Logbook copy	Tandem flights, first 10 with the tandem-rated instructor, hours as PIC and passenger weights shown
6	CA 62.16 application form	From SAHPA Forms & Checklists
7	CA 62.15 skills test form	Completed and signed
8	CA 183-540 consent form	Signed
9	Certified copy of ID or passport, and passport photo	Follow SAHPA's ID & Passport Specifications sheet
10	Licence application fee with proof of payment	Current SAHPA fee schedule

7. Steps

1. Register as a Trainee Tandem Pilot with SAHPA.
2. Fly your first 10 tandem flights with a tandem-rated Grade B instructor or higher.
3. Pass the Tandem exam (85%) and present your medical to get the Authority to Fly.
4. Complete the 40 tandem flights, PIC flights and practical course within one year.
5. Your initiating instructor signs the checklist and does the final sign-off.
6. Submit the documents above to SAHPA for the Committee to consider.
7. Upload your SACAA tandem rating in the Flight Hub when it is issued.

8. Source notes

- CAR Part 62 Subpart 8 (62.08.1(4)); SA-CATS 62 Appendices R62.35 (item 3(i)) and R62.37; SAHPA TPM Part 5 (5.9); SAHPA Forms & Checklists page (2025 packs).
- Part 106 (Hang-gliding and Paragliding) was published as a draft for comment in May 2022; its final status was not confirmed. A SAHPA member's 2021 analysis says the draft removes the high-flights requirement for the standard tandem pilot and raises the Grade C tandem instructor requirement to 200 tandem flights.
- The Grade C Tandem Flight Instructor rating is separate and not covered here. SA-CATS 62 Appendix R62.38 was not read in full.